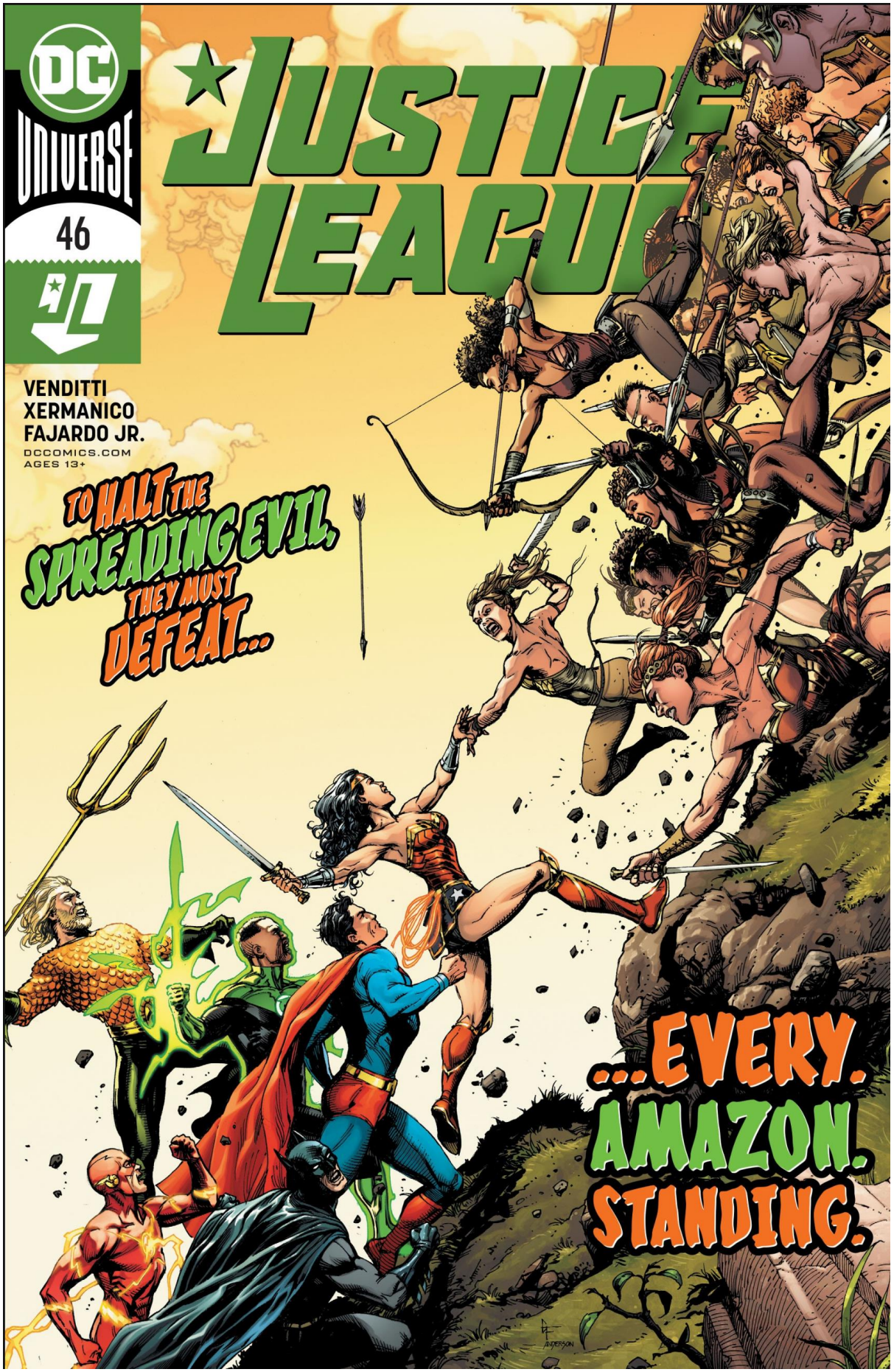
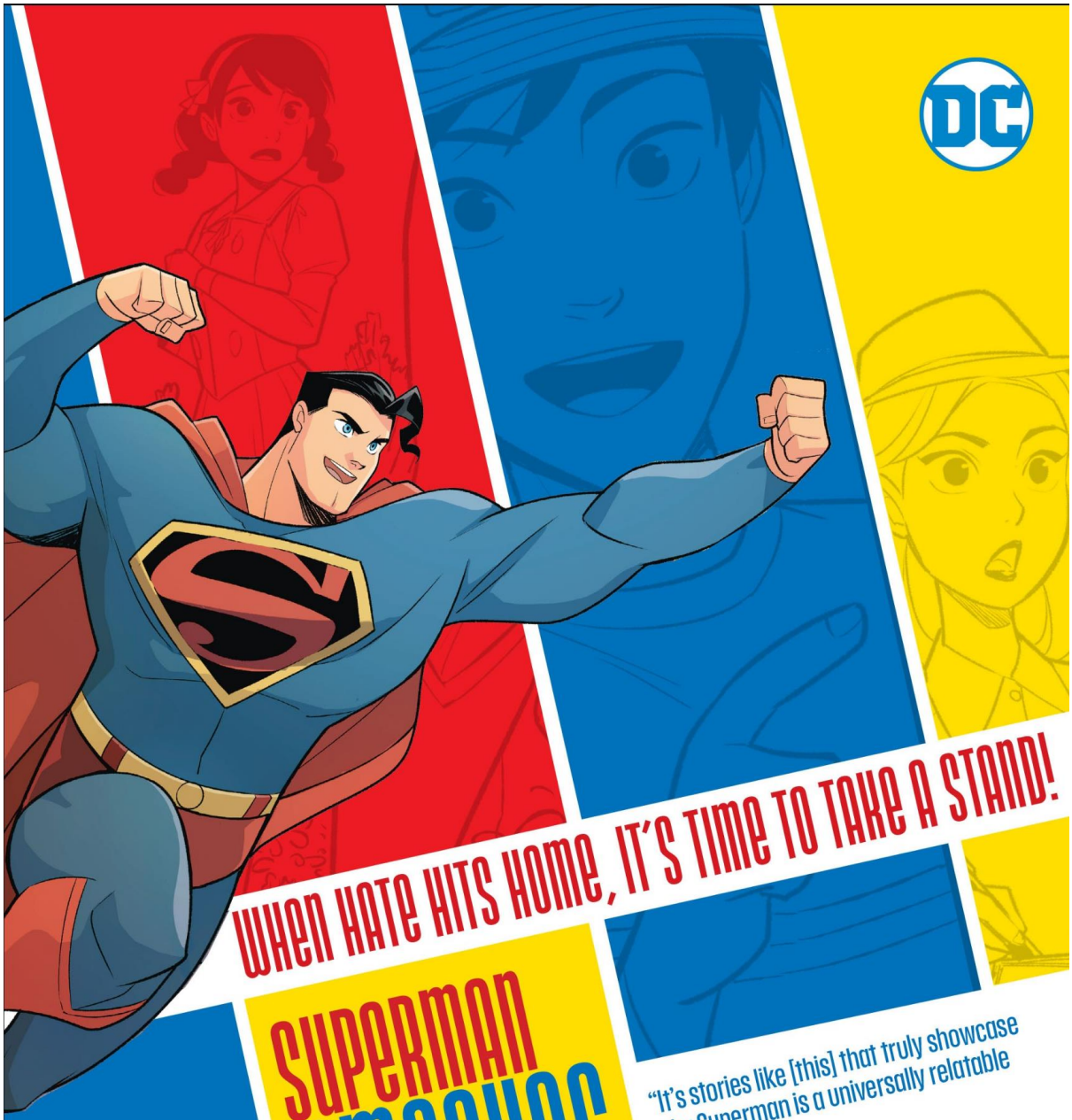

DC UNIVERSE
46
JUSTICE LEAGUE
VENDITTI
XERMANICO
FAJARDO JR.
DCCOMICS.COM
AGES 13+
TO HALT THE SPREADING EVIL, THEY MUST DEFEAT...
...EVERY. AMAZON. STANDING.



When hate hits home, it's time to take a stand!

Superman smashes the Klan

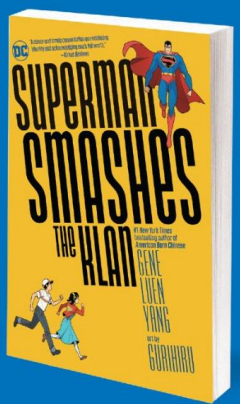
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—Newsweek

"Great tale with lots of character struggle with real world issues."
—AiPT

"A powerful story of hope and unity."
—comicbook.com

Written by #1 New York Times bestselling author
Gene Luen Yang

Illustrated by
Gurihiru



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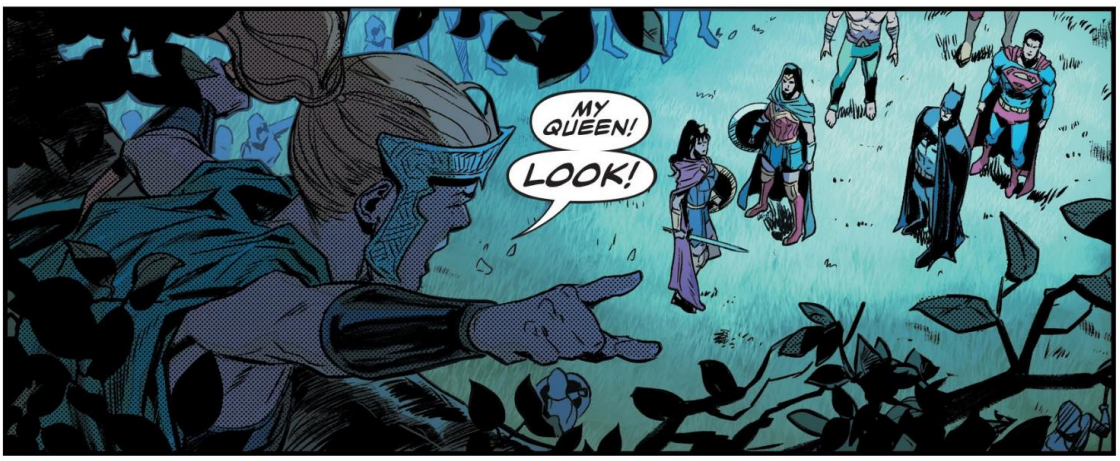
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THEMYSCIRA.
HIDDEN ISLAND OF THE AMAZONS.
WE'RE ON AN URGENT MISSION, SISTERS. MY COMPANIONS AND I MUST REACH TARTARUS BEFORE THE WORLD IS CONSUMED BY VENGEANCE.
SUDDENLY EVERYONE WANTS TO GO TO THE ABYSSAL PRISON OF MONSTERS.
BEFORE YOU, THERE WAS A BROODING MALE IN ODD CLOTHING.
HIS NAME IS JIM CORRIGAN.
HIS SOUL IS THE HUMAN HOST FOR THE SPECTRE-- THE IMMORTAL SPIRIT OF VENGEANCE.
WITH CORRIGAN ABSENT FROM THE EARTHLY PLANE, THE SPECTRE'S VENGEANCE IS UNTEMPERED.
UNLESS HE AND THE SPECTRE ARE REUNITED, THE SPREADING VENGEANCE WILL DRIVE PEOPLE TO MADNESS.
ONLY WITH A THUNDERBOLT FROM ZEUS HIMSELF WERE WE ABLE TO RESIST.
GETTING SPECIAL TREATMENT FROM DADDY AGAIN, EH, DIANA? NOT EVEN ZEUS WOULD INTERFERE ON AMAZON GROUND.
YOU BROUGHT MALES TO OUR ISLAND.
I DON'T CARE WHOSE DAUGHTER YOU ARE--
SHE IS MY DAUGHTER.


AND I AM YOUR QUEEN.
I WILL DECIDE JUDGEMENT.
...OF COURSE, QUEEN HIPPOLYTA.


MOTHER, I--
YOU BROKE OUR MOST SACRED LAW. YOUR COMPANIONS MAY YET PAY IN BLOOD FOR YOUR RASHNESS.


THE LONGER WE WAIT, THE CLOSER THE WORLD GETS TO WIDESPREAD WAR.
YOU CAN'T COMPREHEND THE SPECTRE'S POWER, YOUR MAJESTY. IT'S BEYOND ANY OF US.
YEAH, BATMAN TRIED KILLING SUPERMAN FOR TELLING THE WORLD HE'S CLARK KENT. THEN SUPERMAN TRIED KILLING BATMAN BACK FOR...WELL, BEING HIM.
AND THEN--
QUEEN HIPPOLYTA, WE WANT TO HELP.
TARTARUS IS THE ONLY PLACE WE CAN DO IT. AND YOU GUARD THE GATE.


MY QUEEN!
LOOK!


IT'S HERE.
YOU ALWAYS DISOBEY, CHILD.
A QUEEN--AND A MOTHER--IS NOT TO BE CHALLENGED.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.


KILL THE INTERLOPERS!
COLD WAR
PART 3: INTO HELL
ROBERT VENDITTI WRITER
XERMANICO & ROBSON ROCHA PENCILS
XERMANICO, DANIEL HENRIQUES & ROBSON ROCHA INKS
ROMULO FAJARDO JR. COLORIST
TOM NAPOLITANO LETTERER
GARY FRANK & BRAD ANDERSON COVER
CLAY MANN & TOMEU MOREY VARIANT COVER
ANDREA SHEA ASSOCIATE EDITOR
ALEX R. CARR EDITOR
SUPERMAN CREATED BY JERRY SIEGEL AND JOE SHUSTER.
BY SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT WITH THE JERRY SIEGEL FAMILY.


DON'T HURT THEM!
THEY DON'T SEEM TO HAVE THE SAME HANG-UP!
WONDER WOMAN, THESE ARE YOUR SISTERS. YOUR MOTHER.
IT'S YOUR CALL.
FIRST, ARCHERS WILL SEND A VOLLEY.
BATMAN, HANDLE IT.
HANDLING.


ARCHERS! NOCK!
POOM


NEXT, A THRUST FROM THE SECOND RANK.
GREEN LANTERN, THAT'S YOURS.
SKEWER THEM!
SHAKAK


FLASH! SUPERMAN!
GIVE US SOME DISTANCE!
KRAK
KRAK
KRAK
ON MY SHOULDER, AQUAMAN.
SAY THE WORD.


JUSTICE LEAGUE
ADVANCE!


HOW FAR TO THE GATE?
IT'S AT THE ISLAND'S HEART!
THE CAVERN ONLY REVEALS ITSELF TO THOSE OF AMAZON BLOOD!
FOLLOW ME!
STOP.


YOU LET THEM ESCAPE, QUEEN HIPPOLYTA!
YOU TREAT YOUR DAUGHTER AS THOUGH SHE'S ABOVE US!
MOTHER!
YOU FLAUNT YOUR STRENGTH OVER THE REST OF US!
I'M OUR BEST WARRIOR!
THEY NO LONGER HAVE US TO FOCUS THEIR BATTLE LUST.
...THEIR FIGHT WILL BE TO THEIR DEATHS.


THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT.
GET TO THE CAVERN!
IT WILL REQUIRE AN ARMY TO HOLD THEM ALL AT BAY, JOHN.
I'LL STAY.
WE DON'T KNOW WHAT'S WAITING IN TARTARUS. GETTING CORRIGAN BACK AND SETTING THE SPECTRE RIGHT--THAT'S OUR MISSION.
WE'RE A TEAM. LET ME DO WHAT'S BEST FOR US.
TRUST ME.


THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT!
THE SPECTRE IS RIGHT!
HEY, AMAZONS!
YOU HAVE GRIEVANCES WITH EACH OTHER. WHO DOESN'T?
TRY KILLING ME INSTEAD.
KILL THE INTERLOPER!
MEET MY ARMY.
THE GREEN LANTERN CORPS


MOUNT TARTARUS.
...SISTERS.
THE WATCHWOMEN OF TARTARUS ARE AN ANCIENT AND DEDICATED ORDER.
IF THE SPECTRE'S CORRUPTED VENGEANCE CAN DRIVE THEM TO KILL EACH OTHER, NO ONE IS SAFE.
DIANA...
...I'M SORRY.


PUSH!
WHAT--?
RRRRRRR
RRRAAAGH!
LET'S FINISH IT.


WHERE TO?
IF YOU EXPECT A MAP, I DO NOT HAVE IT.
MY KNOWLEDGE ENDED AT THE GATE.
I KNOW ONLY THAT WE SHOULD NOT LEAVE THE MAW OF TARTARUS OPEN FOR LONG.
FLASH, SCOUT AHEAD.
A SPRINT AROUND HELL? WHAT COULD GO WRONG?
THIS WAY. IT'S...
...YOU HAVE TO SEE FOR YOURSELF.
YOU THERE. WE SEARCH FOR A SOUL FROM THE MORTAL REALM. JAMES CORRIGAN.


SPEAK.
DIANA, WAIT...
...CORRIGAN?
LEAVE IT TO YOU TO FIND ME EVEN HERE, BATS.
BEEN TWENTY YEARS, AND I BET YOU HAVEN'T AGED A DAY.
TWENTY YEARS?
BUT YOU WERE JUST IN GOTHAM...
TIME MOVES FASTER HERE. OR SLOWER.
SOME DAMN THING. I DIDN'T FIGURE TO LAST LONG. THOUGHT THE MONSTERS WOULD PICK ME CLEAN.
THEY SEEM TO KNOW I'M OFF-LIMITS.
EXPLAIN AFTER YOU'VE RETURNED WITH US.
NO! YOU HAVE TO LEAVE!
IT WAS ALL A MISTAKE! I DIDN'T REALIZE--
I KNEW MORE WOULD COME.


THE ANCIENT SEAL STANDS OPEN.
TARTARUS, THE FIRST GOD OF HELL, WILL AT LAST BE FREE.
NEXT: THE SOUL OF THE WORLD!


GET READY FOR THE ENCORE!
DARK NIGHTS
DEATH METAL
THE MAYHEM IS IMMINENT
SCOTT SNYDER | GREG CAPULLO
TM & © DC

SCOTT SNYDER AND GREG CAPULLO TAKE THE STAGE FOR DARK NIGHTS: DEATH METAL

Dark Nights: Metal was one of DC's biggest events ever, with writer Scott Snyder and artist Greg Capullo channeling the energy of their seminal Batman run into a massive story that brought heavy metal thunder across the DC Universe.

In May, Snyder and Capullo re-team for *Dark Nights: Death Metal*, an epic sequel that turns the volume way, way up, and drops DC's heroes in extremely hostile territory—and ties together the last several years of the DC Universe in a bigger, louder, and unexpected encore.

What's the tone of *Death Metal*? In what ways is it similar to the original, and in what ways is this one different for you?

Greg Capullo: One thing that's going to be similar: there will be Joker dragons. They're making an encore! [We're] going bigger and louder. [The first script] is so jam-packed, dense with exciting and great metal-esque comics stuff that I think everyone is going to lose their mind when they get to this.

Scott Snyder: This time we really want to blow the story out through the whole DCU in an even bigger and crazier way. If there were five evil Batmen in the first one, then there's hundreds in this one. If there was a Joker dragon in the first one, then they're just commonplace in the sky in this one. It's that: characters you don't expect to see, characters people are hungering to see Greg draw. It's definitely upping the ante from the first one.



Other than being a natural—and awesome title for a sequel, what can you tease about what "Death Metal" means in this story?

Snyder: There is a "death metal" itself—that's in the story—and there's a reason it's called that, and there's a history to it that ties into a lot of things that we were building both with the Justice Society of America and other characters from the past.

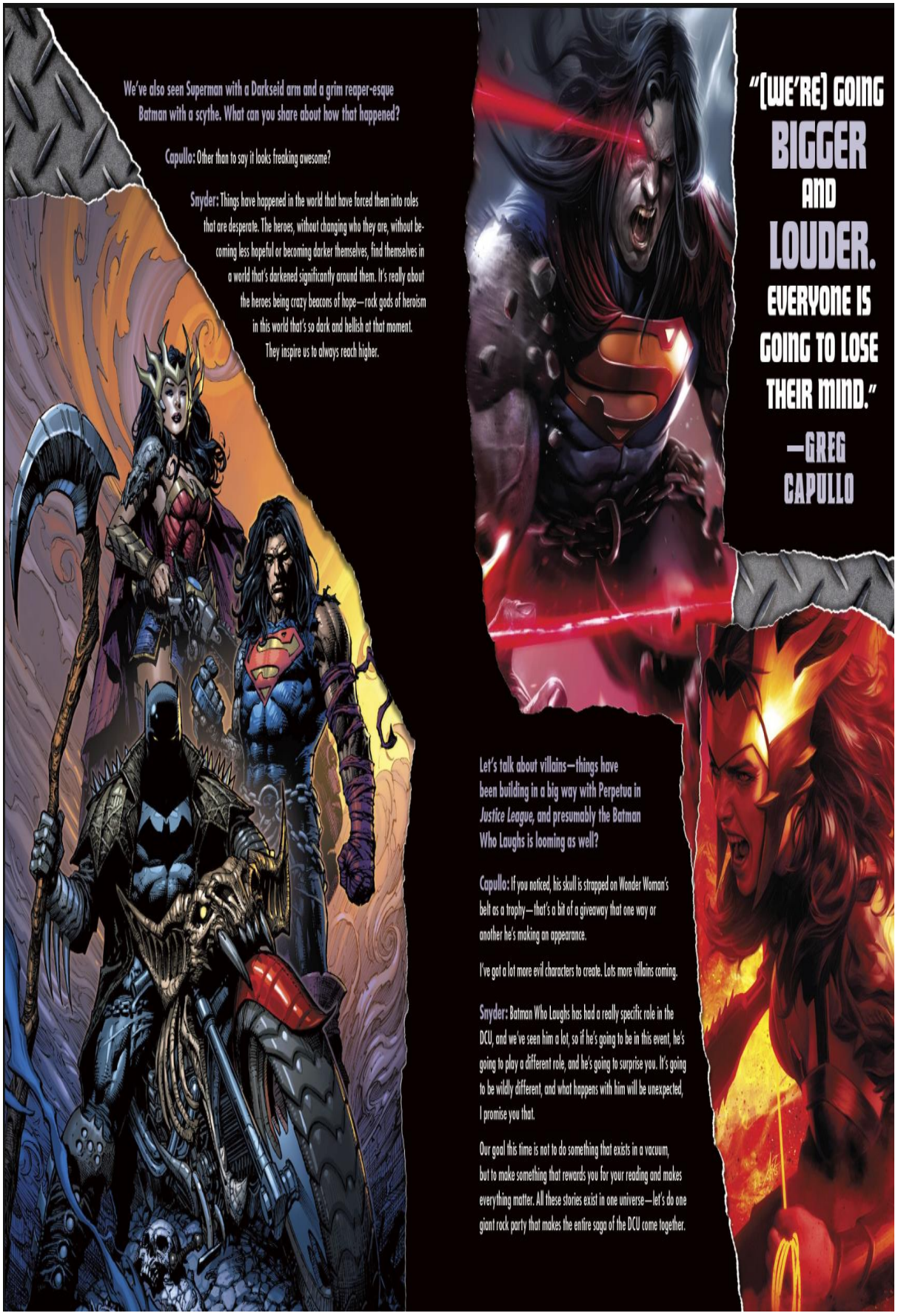
But also—it just sounds cool. There's no turning back. The stakes are higher. Everyone's life is on the line.

Fans have already seen Wonder Woman and her "Chainsaw of Truth." What can you say about the role she plays? Is she a lead character?

Capullo: Definitely, which is exciting for me. I was initially intimidated by Wonder Woman. When Scott gave me this—and she's got such a prominent, up-front role—I was excited. It's no longer intimidation—I'm now excited to portray her as I feel I understand her to be.

Snyder: She's the perfect person for the story. When the story starts, the heroes are in a really bad position. We start in a place that's going to really shock you, and it's a place where the only way out is to discover the truth about not only what happened, but the kinds of terrible things the villains have done over the years—and the truth about what we've done in other stories: in Event Leviathan, in *Doomsday Clock*, and all of that. Wonder Woman is the perfect character to go after the truth, whether it's a lasso, or better yet, a chainsaw.

"ONE GIANT ROCK PARTY THAT MAKES THE ENTIRE SAGA OF THE DCU COME TOGETHER."—SCOTT SNYDER



We've also seen Superman with a Darkseid arm and a grim reaper-esque Batman with a scythe. What can you share about how that happened?

Capullo: Other than to say it looks freaking awesome?

Snyder: Things have happened in the world that have forced them into roles that are desperate. The heroes, without changing who they are, without becoming less hopeful or becoming darker themselves, find themselves in a world that's darkened significantly around them. It's really about the heroes being crazy beacons of hope—rock gods of heroism in this world that's so dark and hellish at that moment. They inspire us to always reach higher.

"[WE'RE] GOING **BIGGER** AND **LOUDER.** EVERYONE IS GOING TO LOSE THEIR MIND."

—GREG CAPULLO

Let's talk about villains—things have been building in a big way with Perpetua in *Justice League*, and presumably the Batman Who Laughs is looming as well?

Capullo: If you noticed, his skull is strapped on Wonder Woman's belt as a trophy—that's a bit of a giveaway that one way or another he's making an appearance.

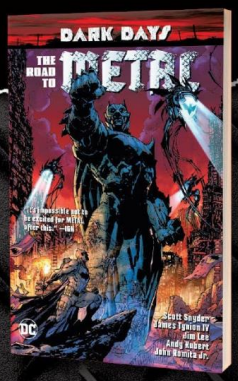
I've got a lot more evil characters to create. Lots more villains coming.

Snyder: Batman Who Laughs has had a really specific role in the DCU, and we've seen him a lot, so if he's going to be in this event, he's going to play a different role, and he's going to surprise you. It's going to be wildly different, and what happens with him will be unexpected, I promise you that.

Our goal this time is not to do something that exists in a vacuum, but to make something that rewards you for your reading and makes everything matter. All these stories exist in one universe—let's do one giant rock party that makes the entire saga of the DCU come together.

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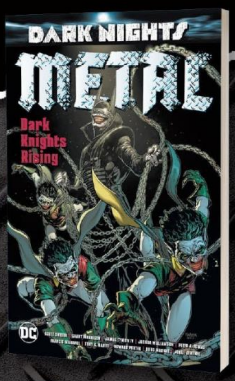
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DARK DAYS: THE ROAD TO METAL



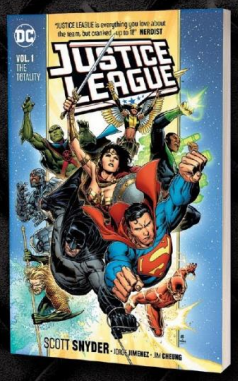
DARK NIGHTS: METAL



DARK NIGHTS: METAL: DARK KNIGHTS RISING



DARK NIGHTS: METAL: THE RESISTANCE



JUSTICE LEAGUE VOL. 1: THE TOTALITY

JUSTICE LEAGUE VOL. 2: GRAVEYARD OF GODS

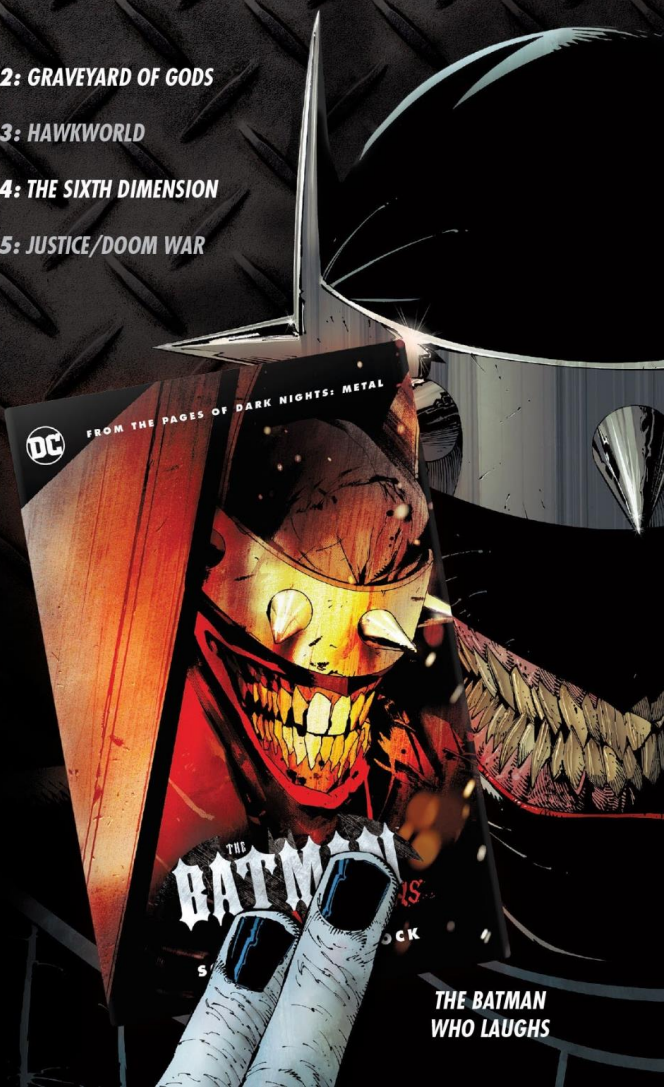
JUSTICE LEAGUE VOL. 3: HAWKWORLD

JUSTICE LEAGUE VOL. 4: THE SIXTH DIMENSION

JUSTICE LEAGUE VOL. 5: JUSTICE/DOOM WAR
(ON SALE IN JUNE)



YEAR OF THE VILLAIN: HELL ARISEN
ON SALE IN JUNE



THE BATMAN WHO LAUGHS

DC NATION SPOTLIGHT ON The Joker

Over the past eight decades, The Joker has consistently been reinvented and reimagined—while remaining one of fiction's most recognizable villains.

In June, comics' top writers and artists pay tribute to the many eras of the Clown Prince of Crime in *The Joker 80th Anniversary 100-Page Super Spectacular* #1. Here are some of his most enduring—and chilling—looks, as illustrated by superstar artist Ryan Sook!



CRIMINAL CLOWN

In the style of:
Neal Adams

The Joker had been out of the spotlight for several years when writer Dennis O'Neil and artist Neal Adams brought him back to his maniacal glory starting with 1973's "The Joker's Five-Way Revenge."



FUTURE FOE

In the style of:
Frank Miller

The Joker of 1986's *The Dark Knight Returns* matches the dystopian future of the seminal story: even more brutal and psychotic, as captured by Frank Miller's unmistakable aesthetic.



ANIMATED ANTAGONIST

In the style of:
Bruce Timm

1992's *Batman: The Animated Series* provided the definitive take on The Joker for a generation of fans, with Bruce Timm's expressive design perfectly paired with vocals by actor Mark Hamill.



VILE VILLAIN

In the style of:
Greg Capullo

Scott Snyder and Greg Capullo's 2012's "Death of the Family" had a distinctly horror twist, as Batman's greatest enemy wore *his own face* as a mask—and it was as gross as it sounds.

LOOK FOR THESE MASKS AT PARTICIPATING LOCAL COMICS SHOPS!

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